

Pimato Sandad (ᩈᩢ᩠ᨦᩣ᩠ᨦ ᩈᩢ᩠ᨦ)

The Pimato Sandad writing system (or also known as Pimato) is an abugida created by Ander Jiloh in 2016. It was invented to give the Kadazandusun language access to the medium of writing as a sovereign space for cultural expression, as the Latin script does not share cultural heritage with the Kadazandusun language. A font, known as Taarau, is developed by Ander Jiloh since 2019.

Pimato simply means 'letters', and *sandad* means 'indigenous'. Put together, *Pimato Sandad* means 'indigenous letters'. The script is also occasionally referred to as *Pimato Tokou* ('our letters'), or *Pimato Momogun* ('letters of the Momogun peoples').

Notable features

- Type of writing system: abugida
- Direction of writing: left to right, or top to bottom from right to left
- Used to write: Kadazandusun, or other indigenous Bornean languages
- It has no inherent vowel (except when writing languages that contain the schwa, in which the schwa is the inherent vowel)
- All open syllables are ligatures, coda consonants attach to the bottom
- All letters have a 'spine'

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onset nucleus	-∅ or -ə*	-a	-i	-u	-o
k-	ᵏ	ᵃ	ᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃ
g-	ᵍ	ᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ
d-	ᵀ	ᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ
b-	ᵇ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ
t-	ᵀᵀ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ
p-	ᵀᵀᵀ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ
h-	ᵀᵀᵀᵀ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ
r-	ᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ
s-	ᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ
y- (/j/)	ᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ
w-	ᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ
m-	ᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ
n-	ᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ
ng- (/ŋ/)	ᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ
l-	ᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ
v-	ᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ
z-	ᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ
j- (/dʒ/)	ᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ
c- (/tʃ/)	ᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀᵀ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ	ᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃᵃ

Songkolindogunganan ii nokito ku i Kodundungan
Mood-ngood podtizukan tu do hinisou do paai
Kagasan zou intuu' do paai, olonggivitan daa diho tamahang
Bambaazon kinodim za, Kadazan no tinaau za

Nung osongkosuvazan i nosoou zu, odondoman matuu koposizon zu
Nga sooupama ingkaa om ingkaa ii
Zadaai tangalaat do oukab no daa i totombol do kovosian

Siizo', atapo', ondika, inandoi
Pampang mivid-hivid, dandaas mindai-indai
Bontugo', pantango' kohimpantazan
Songkoduiduiza, ohimbaavagan ko-inggang-an

Sisindion, Mr Lojitin 2026

Further information

GitHub repo for the Taarau font, with other supporting materials:

<https://github.com/andergisomon/taarau>

Endangered Alphabets blog post:

<https://www.endangeredalphabets.com/2024/06/24/kadazandusun-or-pimato-the-case-for-a-new-malayan-script/>